Before a planned procedure

Ask weeks ahead, by email or portal, so the answers come in writing. Start with the surgeon's office, because its answers give you the names and codes for the other questions.

- [ ] Ask the surgeon's office for the CPT codes it will bill, whether you'll be an inpatient or an outpatient, whether prior authorization is approved and its reference number, and who else will bill you. **procedure-surgeon.txt**
- [ ] Ask your plan whether the surgeon, the facility, the anesthesia group and everyone else who will bill is in network on that date, how much of your deductible and out-of-pocket maximum is left, and what the plan allows for each code. **procedure-plan.txt**
- [ ] Ask the facility whether any clinician with a part in the procedure will be out of network, including anyone who reads a sample or an image, and what its self-pay price is. **procedure-facility.txt**
- [ ] You don't have to sign a notice-and-consent form that gives up your No Surprises Act protections. You can say so in writing ahead of time.
- [ ] Paying for it yourself? Ask for one all-in price in writing, what it leaves out, and what a complication would cost. Each provider owes a self-pay patient a good-faith estimate. **procedure-bundle.txt**
- [ ] Insured through work? Ask HR whether the plan offers a bundled price, a travel-surgery or center-of-excellence benefit, or a case manager for planned surgery. **procedure-employer.txt**
- [ ] If a device will be implanted, you can ask that the manufacturer's representative be kept out of the sterile field, and that your chart say so.

General information about how health care works, not medical or legal advice. Nothing here should delay care in an emergency. The letters named here are free at healthusersguide.com.